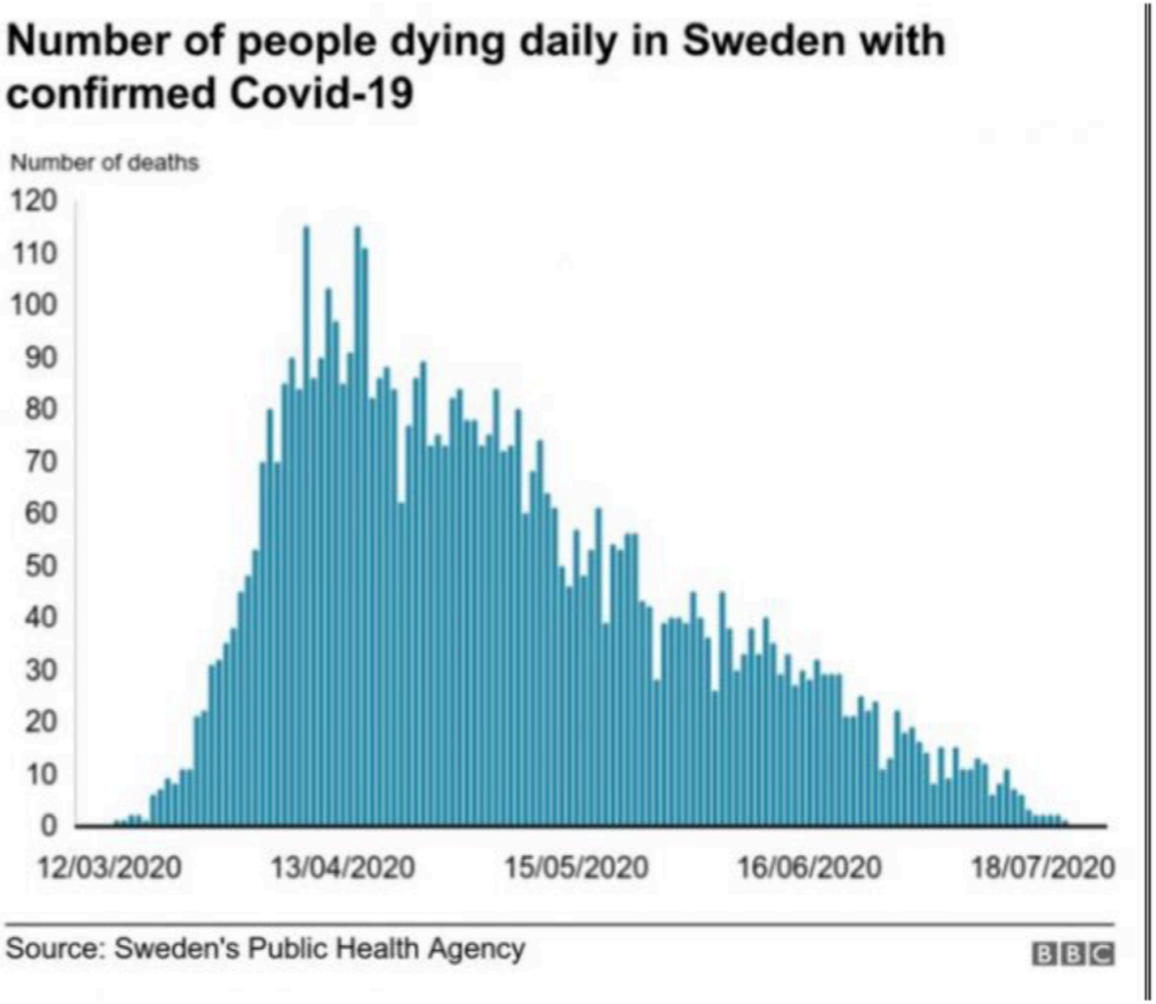
Misleading Visual Tricks

How people lie with charts

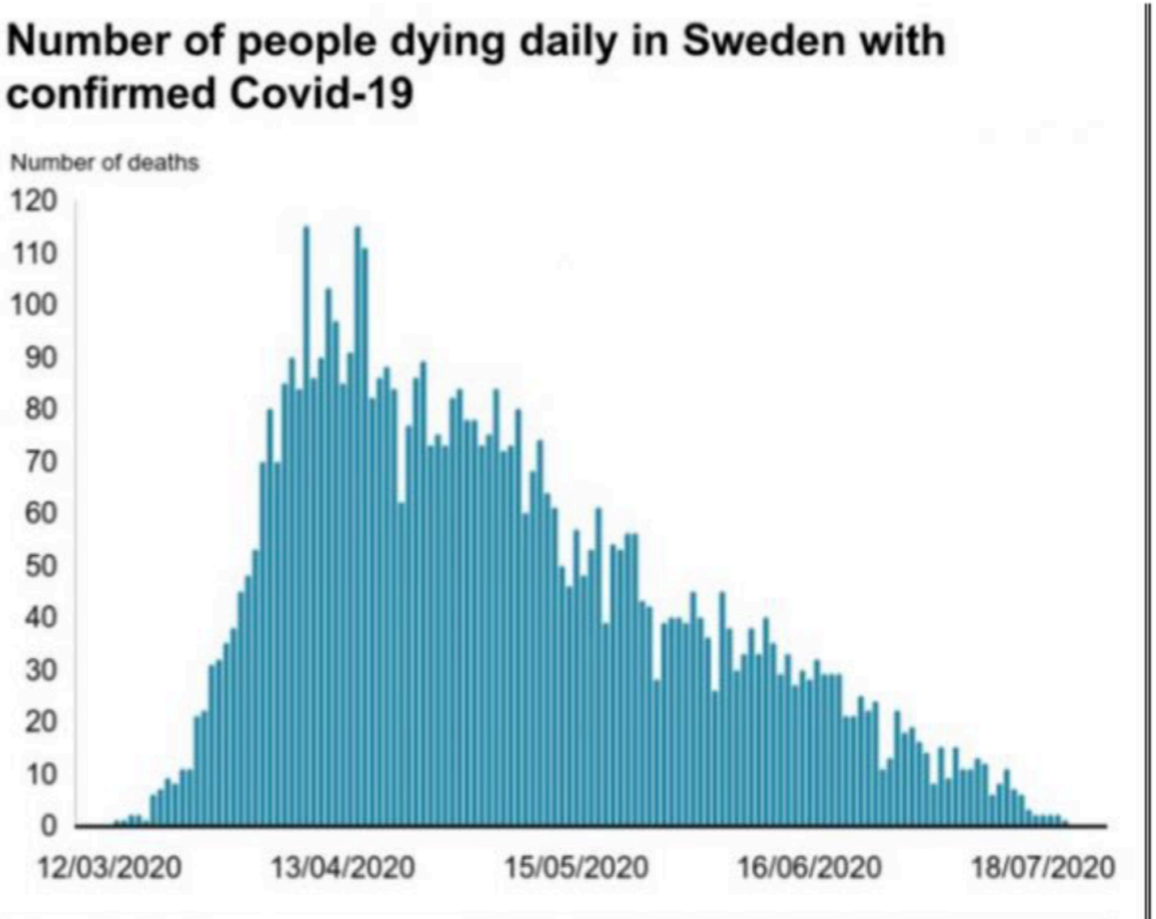
Theo Myrvold

Misleading interpretation

@brithume Case in point, Sweden. Covid is over! 👇



@brithume Case in point, Sweden. Covid is over! 👇



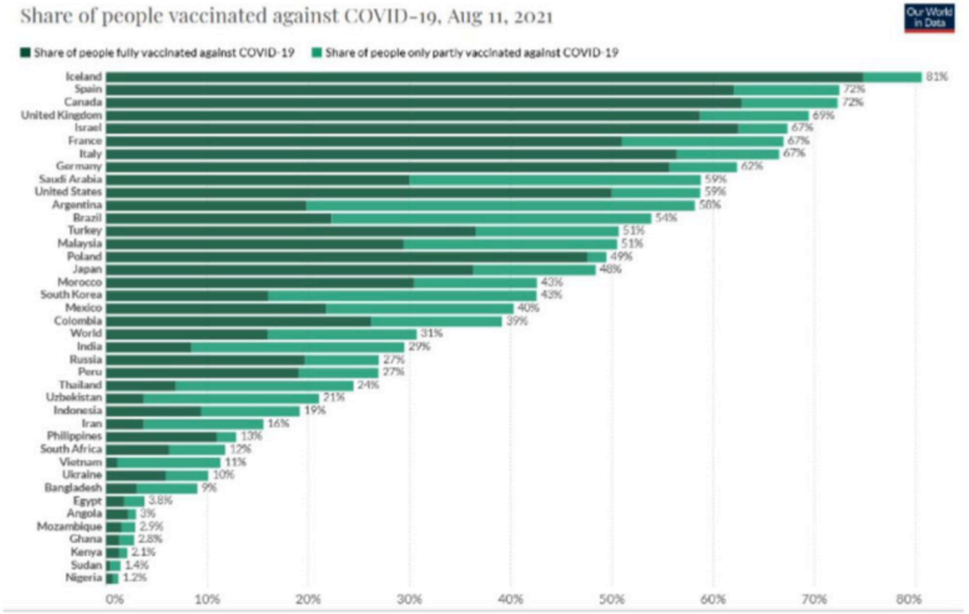
Cherry picking

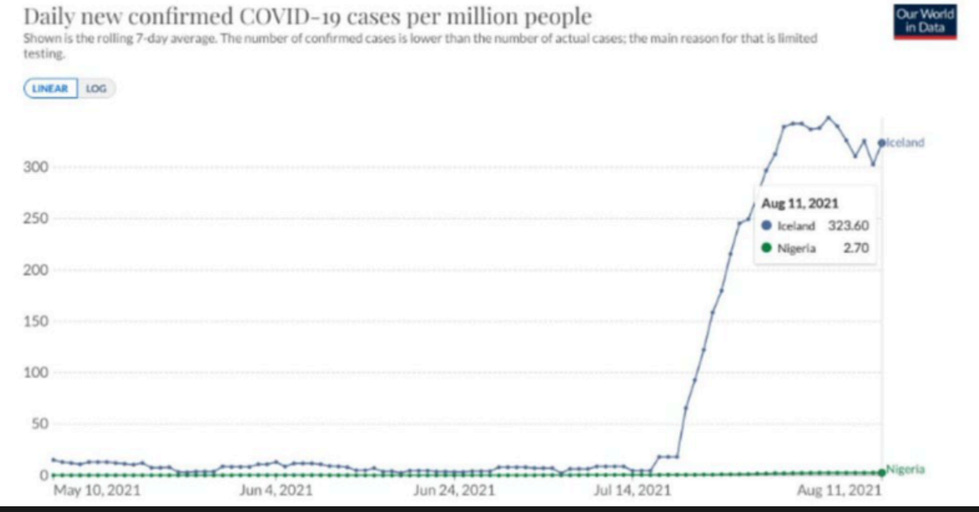
Excludes other countries

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases

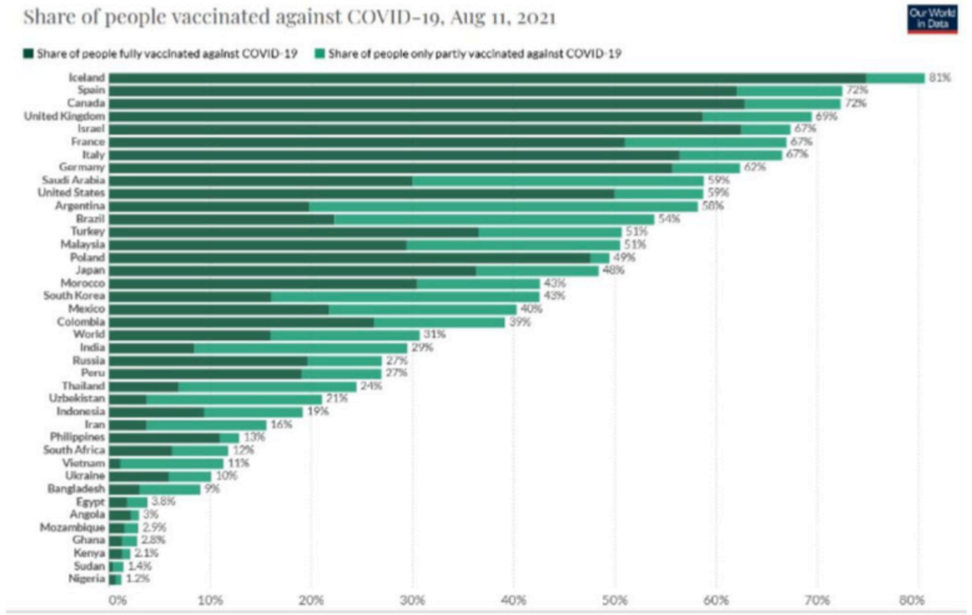


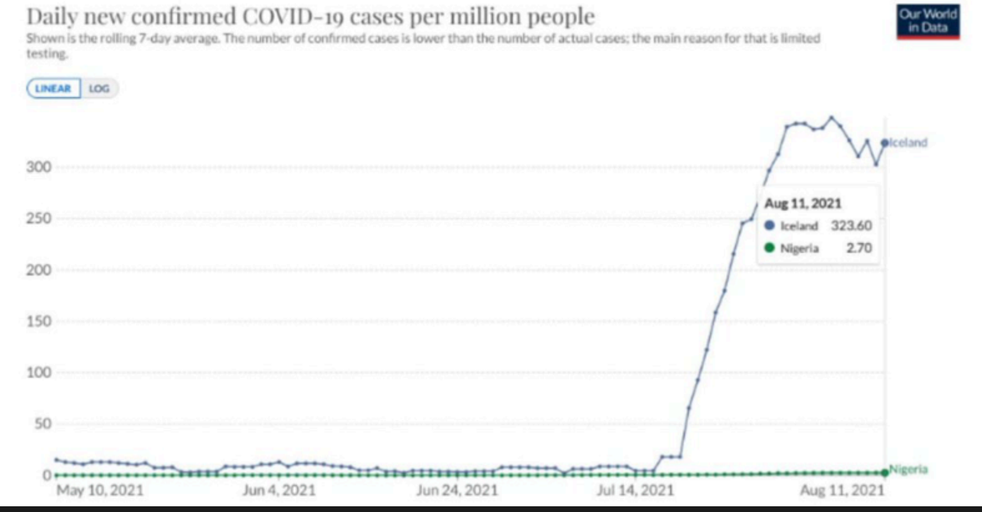


Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases



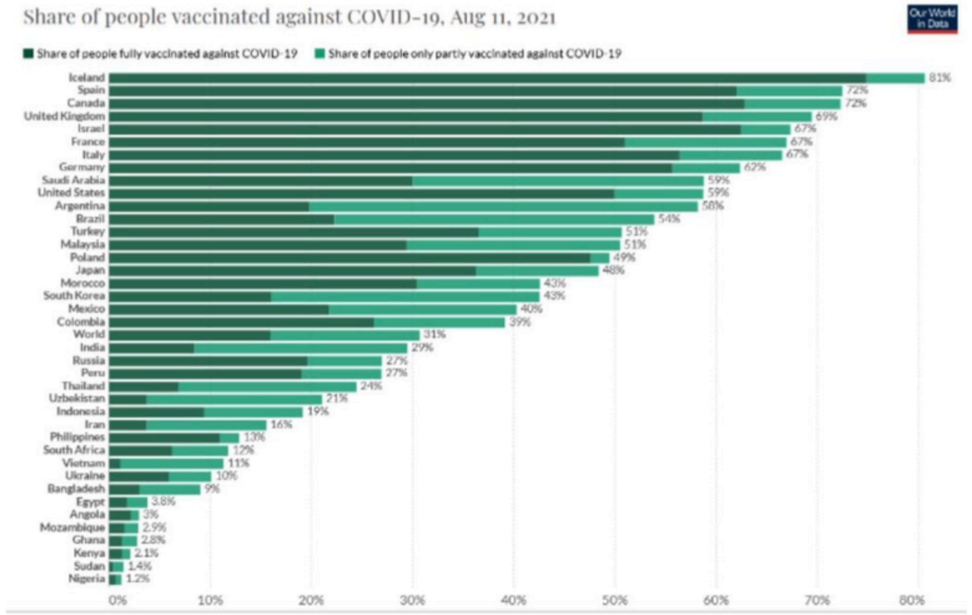


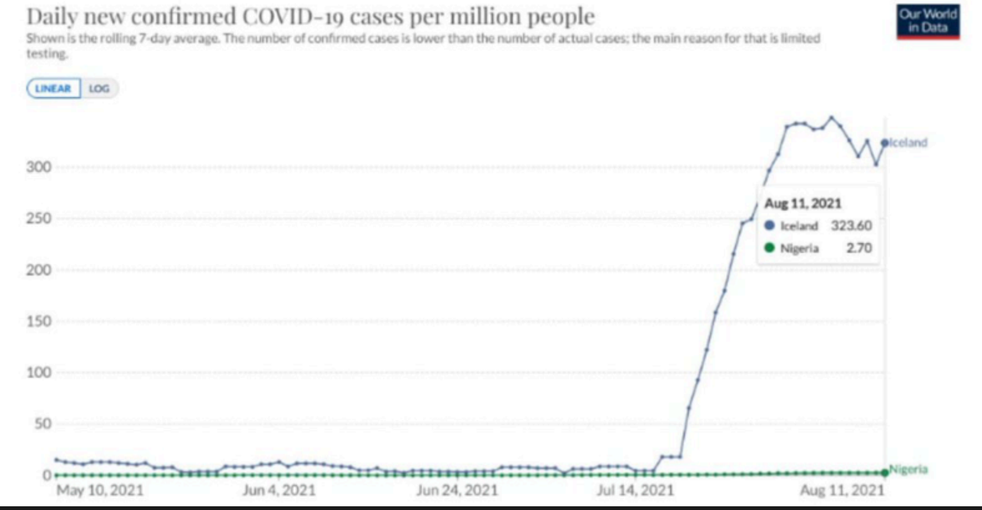
Reasoning error

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





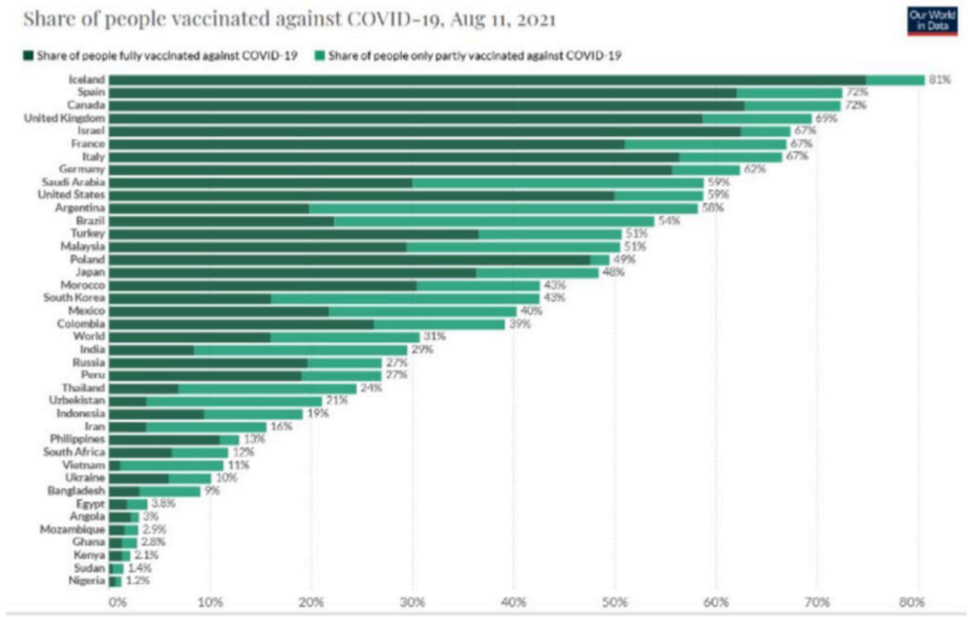
Reasoning error

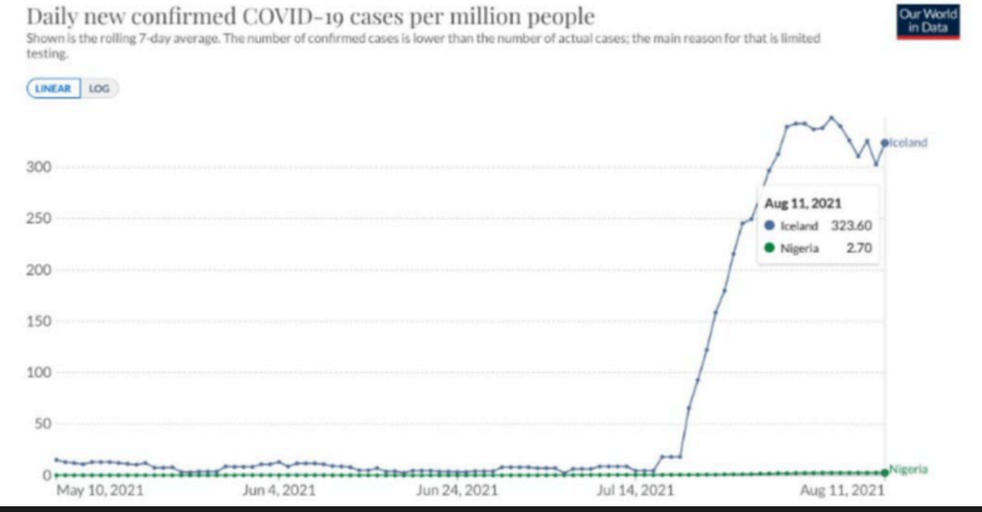
Cherry picking

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Reasoning error

Cherry picking

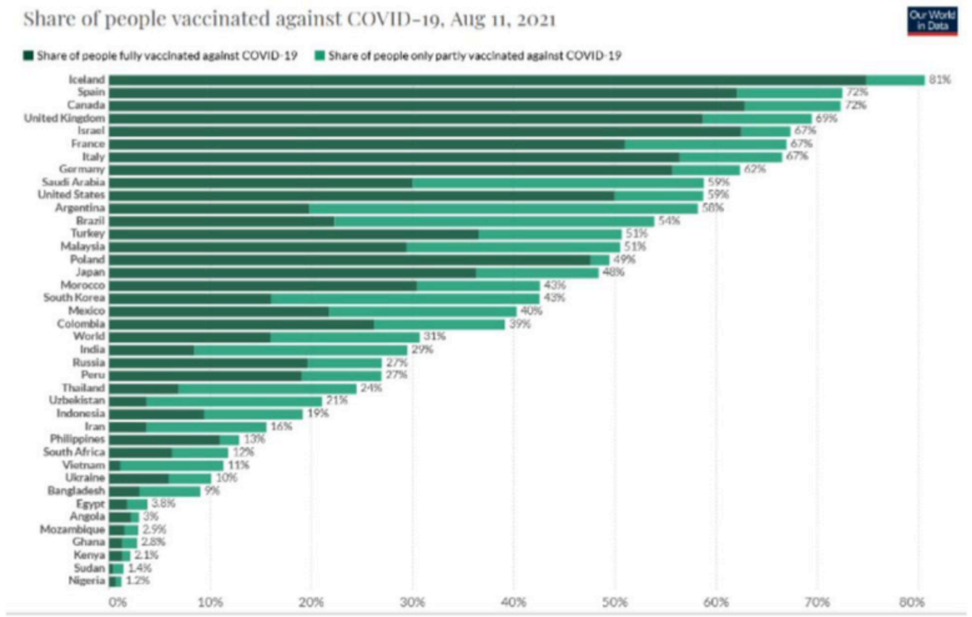
Correlation ≠ causation

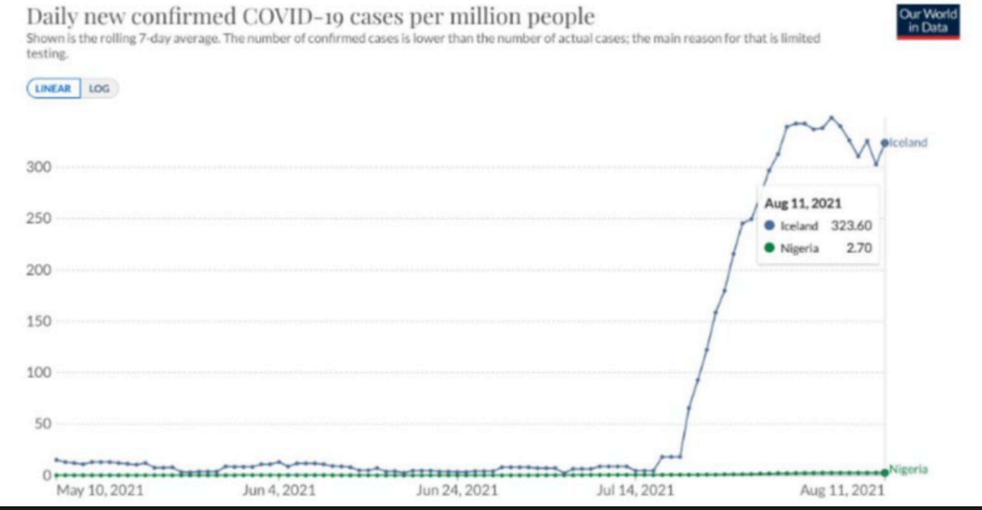
- high vaccination -> more cases

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Reasoning error

Cherry picking

Correlation ≠ causation

- high vaccination -> more cases

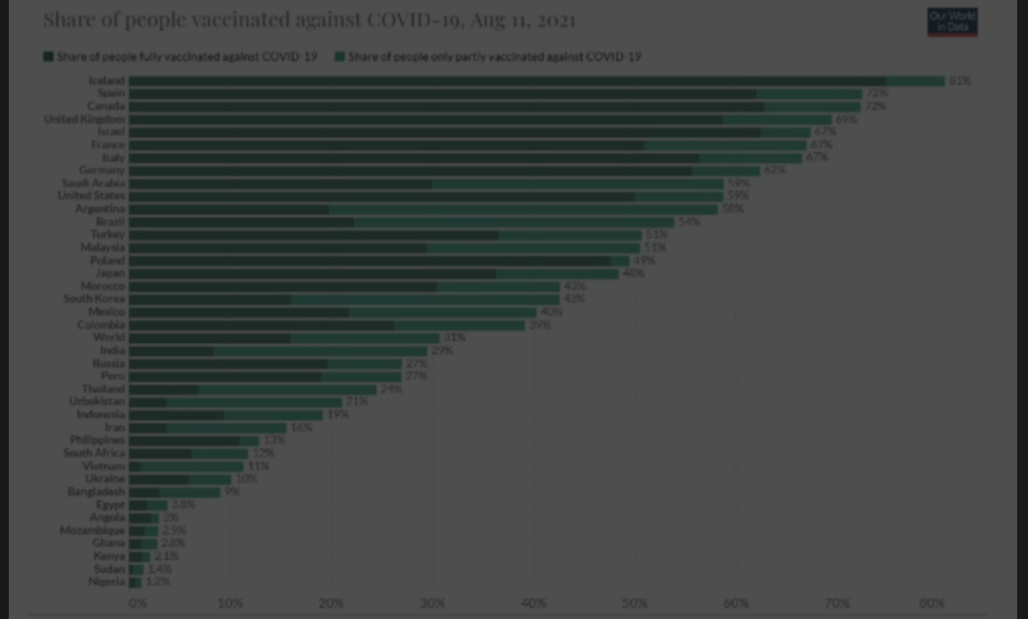
Data quality

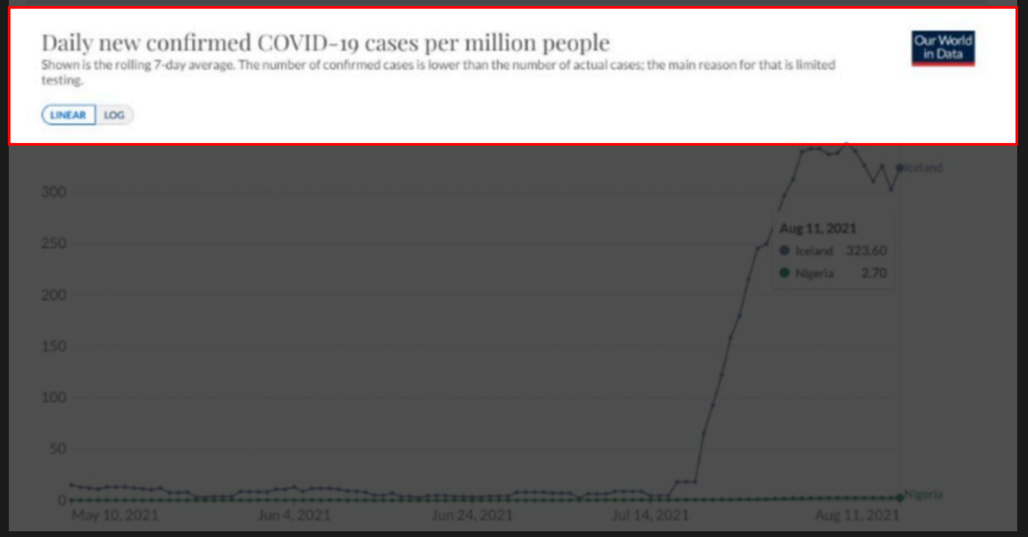
- Iceland tested 200 times more per Capita

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Reasoning error

Cherry picking

Correlation ≠ causation

- high vaccination -> more cases

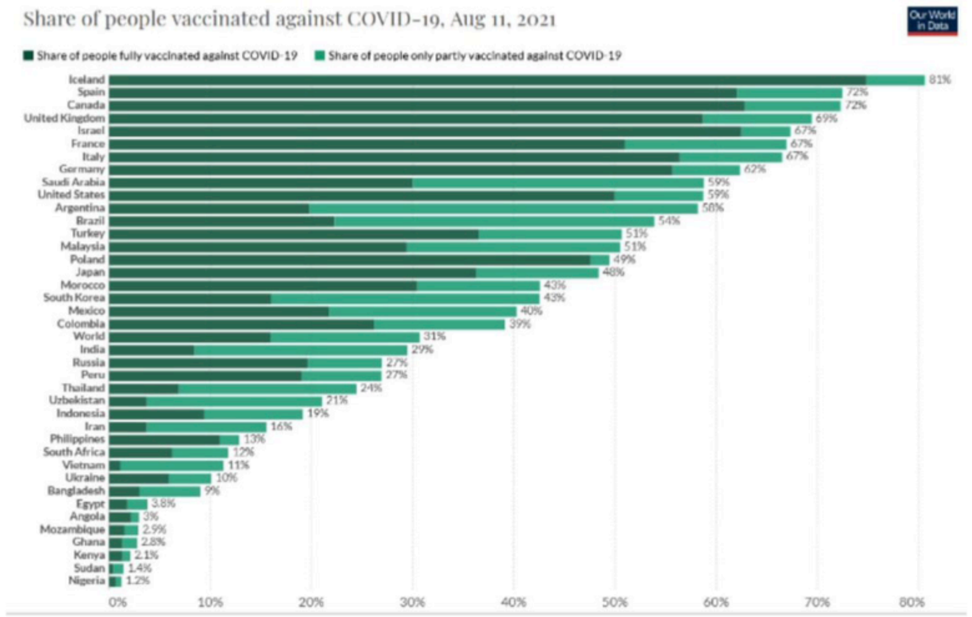
Data quality

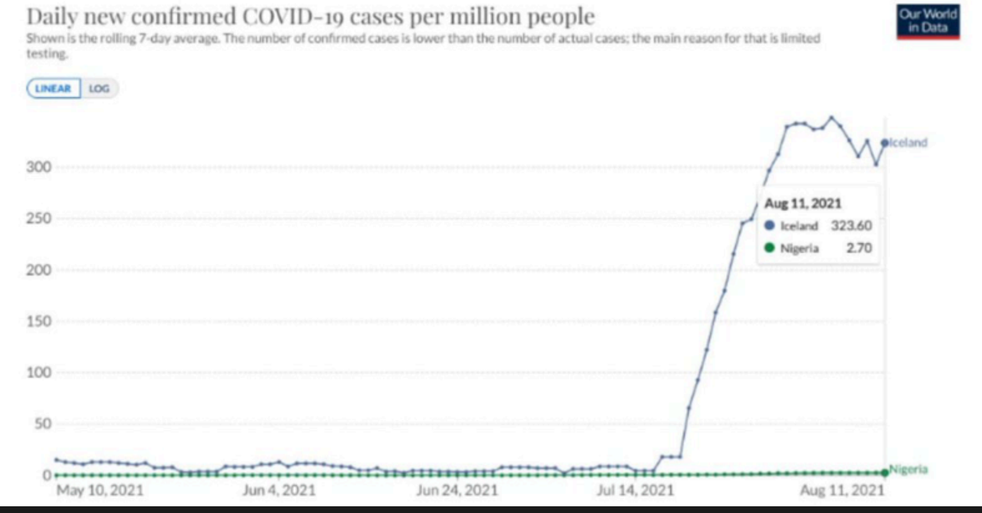
- Iceland tested 200 times more per Capita

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Reasoning error

Cherry picking

Correlation ≠ causation

- high vaccination -> more cases

Data quality

- Iceland tested 200 times more per Capita

Very different countries

-Extremes

-Health systems, population density, wealth

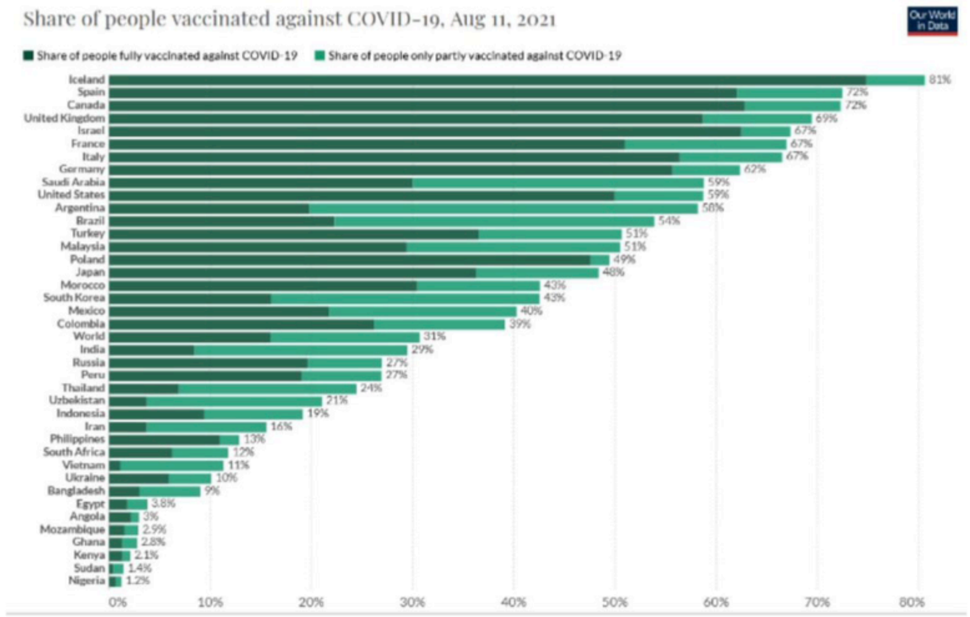
Vulnerable visualization

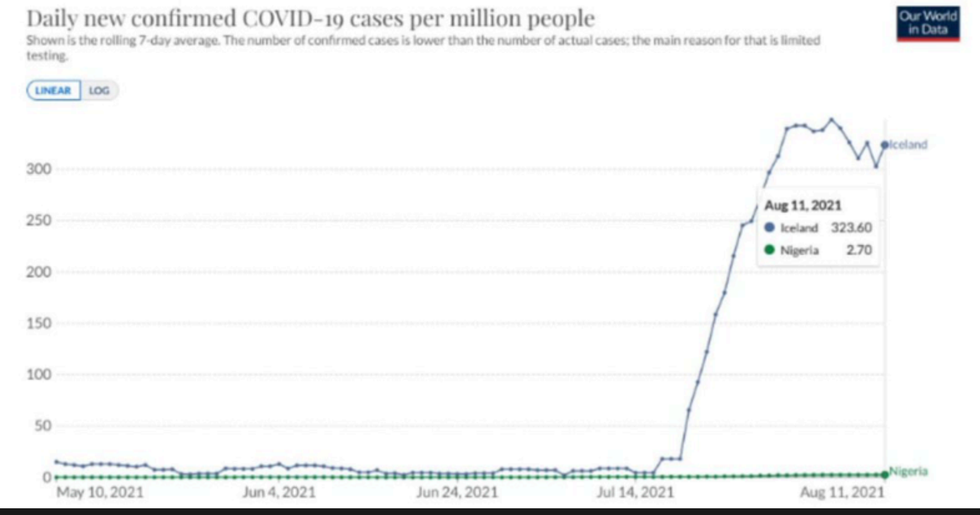
- Maybe no intent to misinform?

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Reasoning error

Cherry picking

Correlation ≠ causation

- high vaccination -> more cases

Data quality

- Iceland tested 200 times more per Capita

Very different countries

-Extremes

-Health systems, population density, wealth

Design violations



Anders Ygeman @Ygeman · Aug 30

Det har varit fyra förlorade år för klimatet med Tidö.

Och det kommer bara bli värre med 12 SD-statsråd.

Det är dags att ta klimatet på allvar.





Truncated axis

Anders Ygeman @Ygeman · Aug 30

Det har varit fyra förlorade år för klimatet med Tidö.

Och det kommer bara bli värre med 12 SD-statsråd.

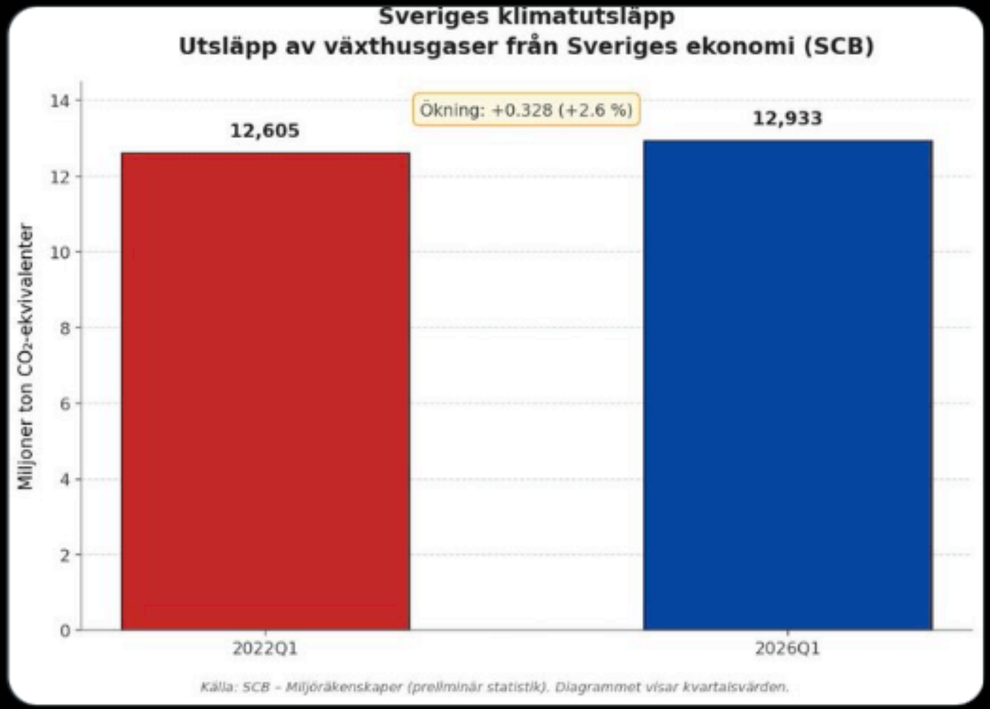
Det är dags att ta klimatet på allvar.



Jesper Ingre @JesperIngre · Aug 30

Här får du helt gratis en korrekt version av ditt diagram. Samma tal, men en hederlig y-axel.

Din fixering vid ”12 SD-ministrar” kan jag tyvärr inte åtgärda. Men den kanske släpper när ni väl presenterar ert eget valmanifest och inte längre behöver fantisera om andra partier?



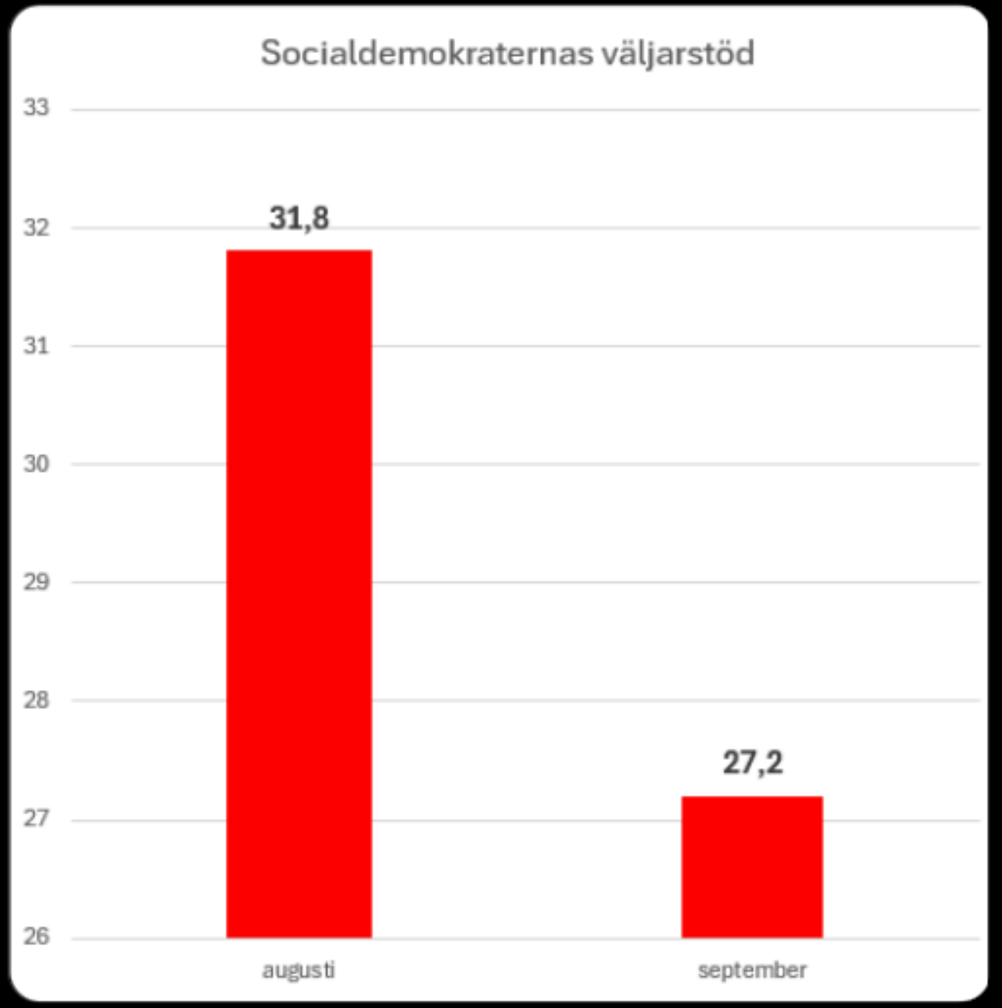
10 93 1.1K 12K



Thomas Nordvall
@NordvallThomas

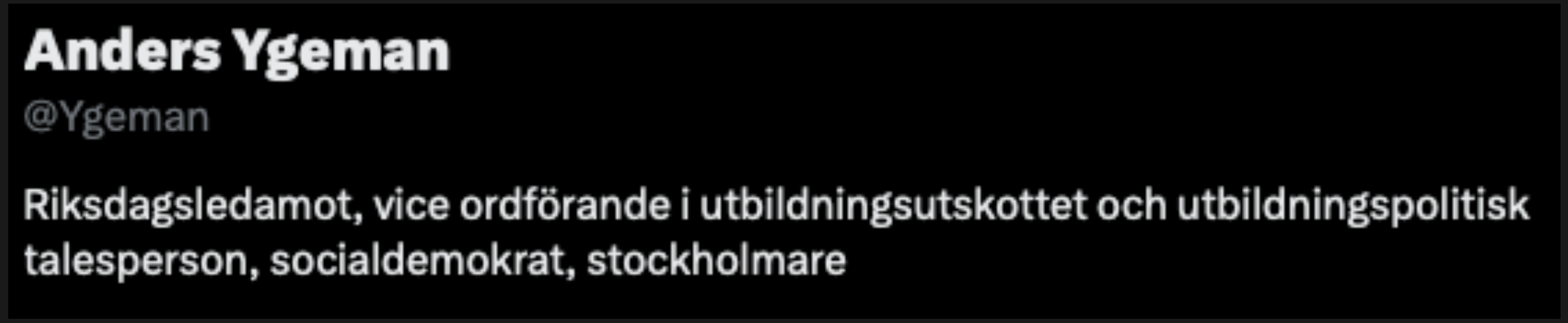
Show translation

Egentligen är @socialdemokrat nedgången så stor att man inte behöver använda @Ygeman trunkerad-y-axel-metod för att se skillnaden.



2:32 PM · Sep 2, 2026 · **8,771** Views

Ethical considerations



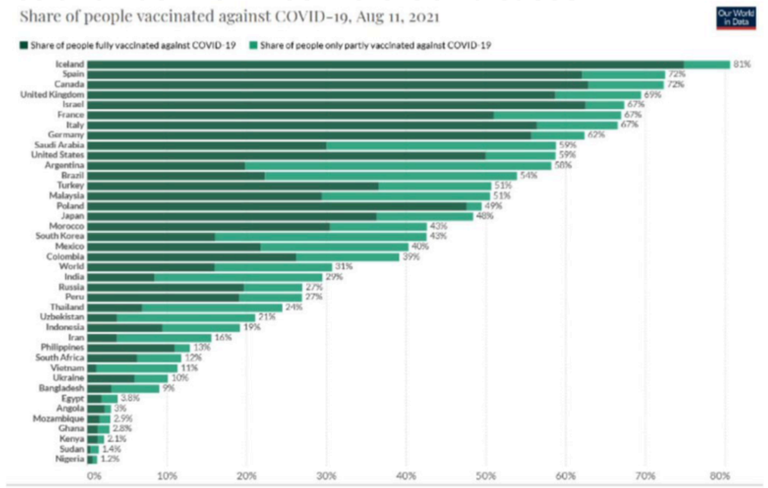
“Member of Parliament, Deputy Chair of the Committee on Education, and education policy spokesperson for the Social Democrats, based in Stockholm.”

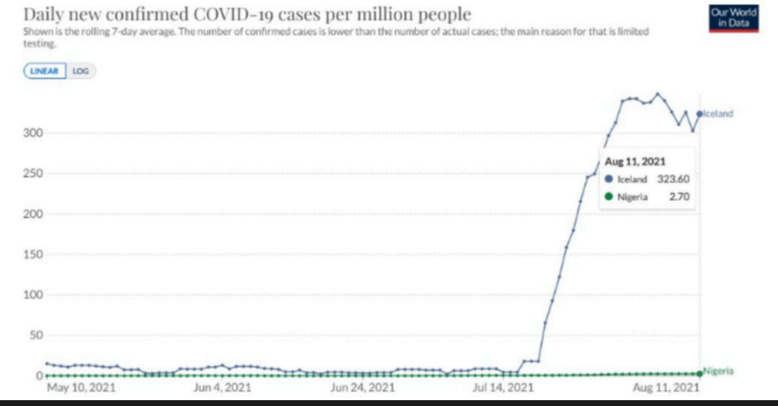
Ethical considerations

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases





Anders Ygeman

@Ygeman

Riksdagsledamot, vice ordförande i utbildningsutskottet och utbildningspolitisk talesperson, socialdemokrat, stockholmare



Anders Ygeman @Ygeman · Aug 30

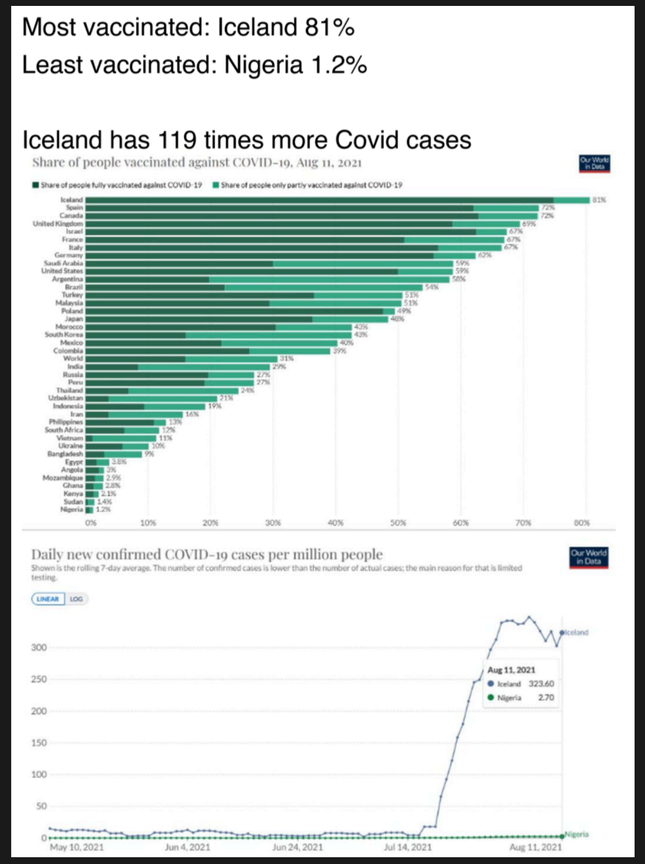
Det har varit fyra förlorade år för klimatet med Tidö.

Och det kommer bara bli värre med 12 SD-statsråd.

Det är dags att ta klimatet på allvar.



Ethical considerations



- Civillian
- Lacking context
- His beliefs



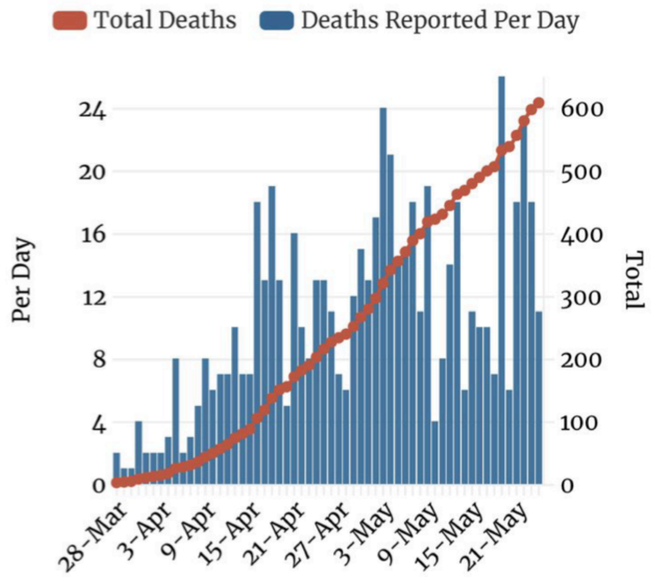
- politician

A sad milestone: today Rhode Island's coronavirus death toll passed 600 people

65° WPRI.com EYEwitness NEWS

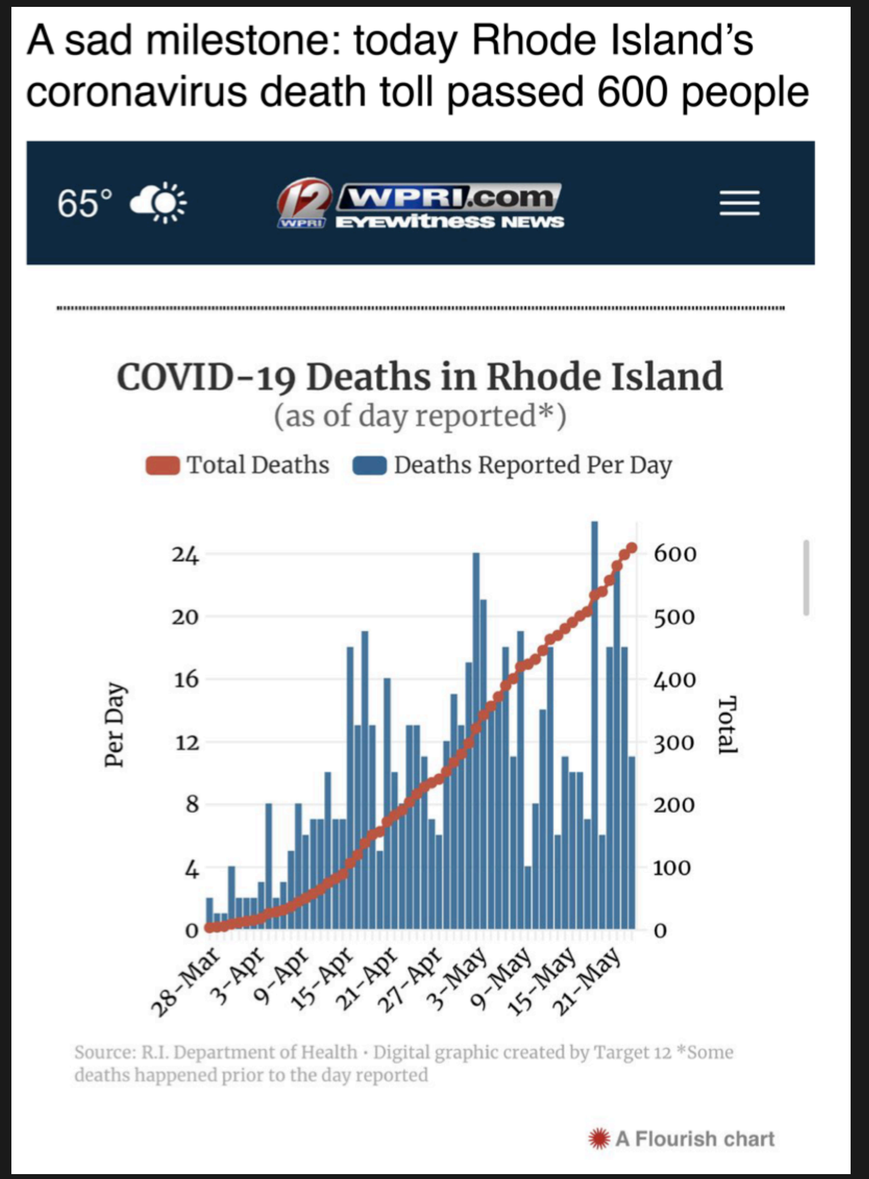
COVID-19 Deaths in Rhode Island

(as of day reported*)



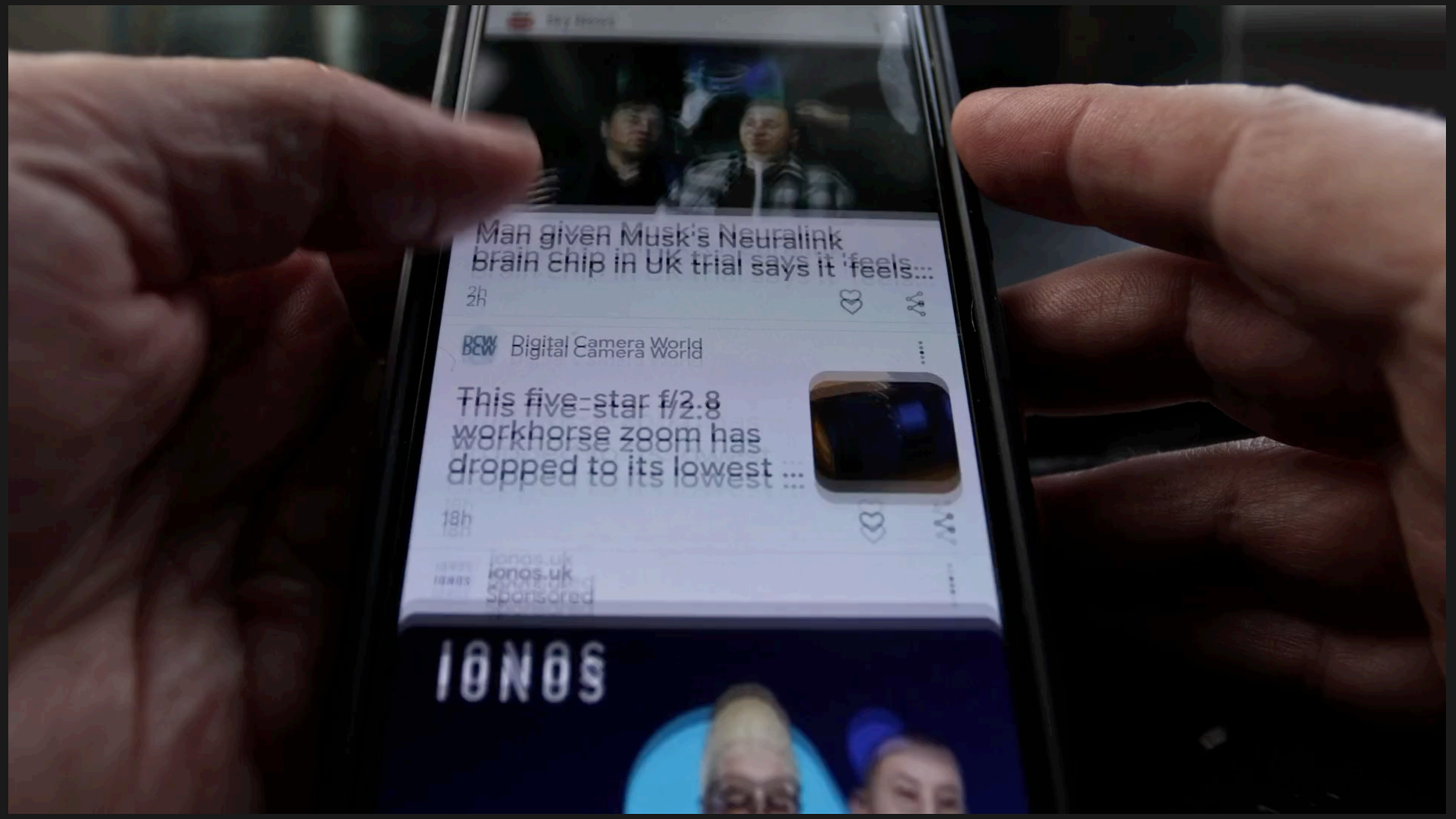
Source: R.I. Department of Health · Digital graphic created by Target 12 *Some deaths happened prior to the day reported

A Flourish chart



Dual axis

-Easy to misinterpret as, daily deaths are in the hundreds



Fast paced media format

Conclusion

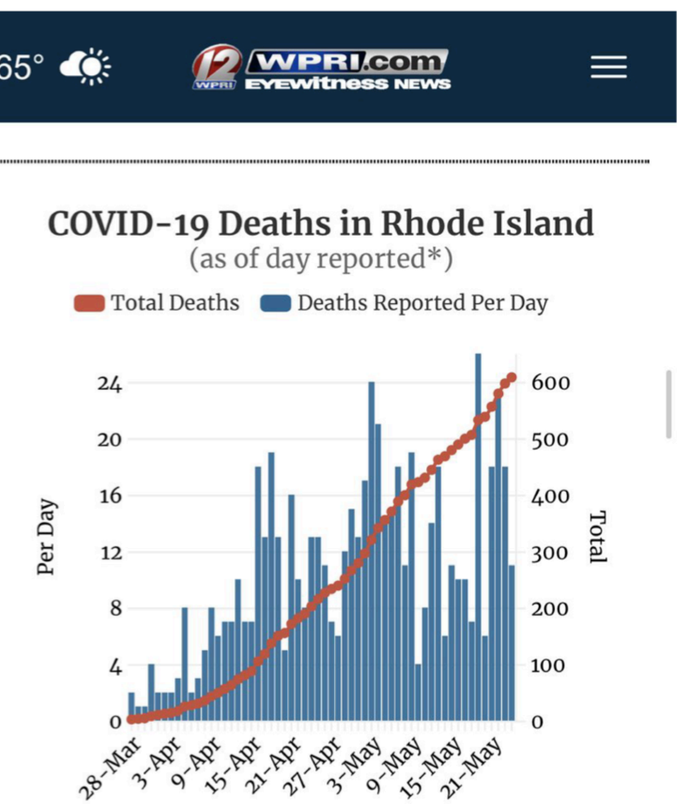
Conclusion

Conclusion

Bad design ≠ Misinformation

A sad milestone: today Rhode Island's coronavirus death toll passed 600 people

65° WPRI.com EYEWITNESS NEWS

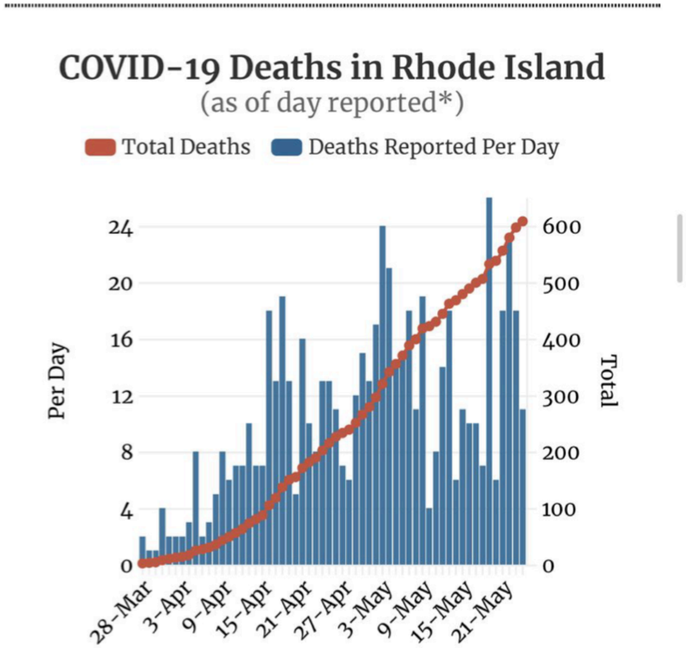


Conclusion

Bad design ≠ Misinformation

A sad milestone: today Rhode Island's coronavirus death toll passed 600 people

65° WPRI.com EYEWITNESS NEWS



Good design ≠ Correct interpretation

Most vaccinated: Iceland 81%

Least vaccinated: Nigeria 1.2%

Iceland has 119 times more Covid cases

